Steve's workshop is just 3.5 metres long by 2.5 metres wide. An exercise in compact working and storage

Chess – chess pieces in box and rosewood

Chessboard – sycamore base inlaid with oak and sapele squares, recovered from old flooring belonging to the customer

LIKES

- Burrs, especially oak
- Demonstrators who talk about what they are doing, give lots of basic detail – such as lathe speed, gouge make and size, type of timber – and don't take anything for granted in terms of what they should or should not tell their audience
- Looking at other people's woodturning
- Working with a customer on a unique design to suit their needs
- Recovering from an error on a piece, sometimes improving on the original intention

DISLIKES

- Gluing pieces together. Clamping awkward shapes and dealing with glue that might seep out are not in my fun to-do list
- People who email to request a piece, or ideas for a piece, but then never follow up. Even a 'sorry, but I have sourced the work elsewhere' would be better than nothing
- Manufacturers who sell items in kits or 'packages', but not as individual components. Half a dozen chucks are useful, but not half a dozen chuck keys, or half a dozen 50mm jaws
- Coming up with a price for work
- The noise that dust extractors and filters make
- Throwing anything away. I use any pieces of wood that are viable, if not they are put on the wood burner as kindling or fuel. Shavings and sawdust are all put on the compost heap and mixed with grass clippings. The downside is finding places to keep everything until a use occurs!

HANDY HINTS

- Photograph every piece you make. Once it is sold or given away, you cannot show it to someone, but a photo allows at least an idea of what you make to be shown to someone else
- Inkjet printing will transfer from paper on to wood with light rubbing on the reverse of the paper. As desktop publisher packages or word processors usually have WordArt options to fit lettering to shapes and rotate and flip options to create mirror images, this allows lettering to be designed on a computer before transferring to wood for pyrography
- It pays to keep your workshop tidy; a place for everything and everything in its place. If only I could follow this advice!

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